

art

Abstract Insight

KOLKATA 'Amurta' roughly translates into 'formless' or 'non-figurative'. But the exhibition does much more than bring together a few abstractionists from Bhopal—it gives us an insight into the evolution of the city's art movement. The crowning names are Jagdish Swaminathan, M.F. Husain and S.H. Raza, along with a host of younger artists from Bhopal.

The show, curated by Akhilesh, is broad-based and attempts to trace the journey of the mystic abstractionism that grew out of Bhopal (boosted by Swaminathan's founding the Bharat Bhavan during the 1980s) and percolated to other cities as the artists took their art with them. A vintage Husain shares space with a geometrical Raza and an N.S. Bendre.

Four of Swaminathan's works are on display, the largest of them depicting a bird flying over a forest. An exhibition of Swaminathan's early works has come to Kolkata after a long time. Three of his four paintings were done during the '60s, and have a refreshing folksy quality about them; the large painting of the bird is more the Swaminathan we are familiar with.

Also interesting are the ways in which the younger artists' usage of materials. Smriti Dixit creates a tapestry out of black and white textile; Mahendra Soni depicts illusionism with vegetables. Akhilesh works with ink and brush on paper to create black and white waves. Other artists include the likes of Seema Ghurayya, Yogendra Tripathi, Awdhesh Vajpai, Nagesh Sharma, to name a few. On at Akar Prakar till September 31.

by Swagata Sen

BIRD OVER A FOREST: One of Swaminathan's early works



music

Celebrating a Legend

DELHI One of the most colourful personalities of Indian music is ghazal queen Begum Akhtar. Her singing symbolised the ultimate romanticism in music and poetry and she underlined it with her distinctive style. Kaladharmi Baag presents Jamal-e-Begum Akhtar, a four-day international ghazal festival to commemorate the beginning of the centenary celebrations of Akhtar between October 4-7 at the India International Centre. The brain behind this festival, Rita Ganguly, one of Akhtar's disciples, says ghazal is an emotional balm to soothe frayed nerves. The line-up includes, besides Ganguly, Anup Jalota, Pankaj Udhas, Vithal Rao from Hyderabad, Tina Sani from Pakistan and Swamy Zubair from Bangladesh. The programme will be anchored by actor Farooque Sheikh. A commemorative publication and a double-CD album *Age Mohabbat*, specially designed for this occasion, will also be released.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

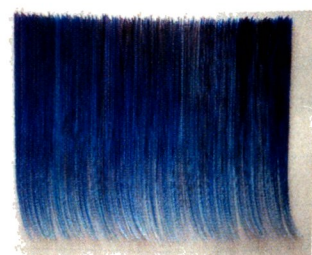
ON A SONG: Jalota pays tribute to Begum Akhtar



art

Vibrant Strokes

MUMBAI Vibrant Strokes is an abstract show by eight artists from Mumbai, Delhi and Chennai, with 16 works in oil, mixed media, pigments on paper, acrylic, dyed pulp cast and water colours. Mumbai's Prafulla Dahanukar's oil-on-canvas is a splash of shades of crimson; Jinsook's 'Moonlight' is a pigments-on-paper in hues of blue. One of the largest works is a



Jinsook's Moonlight

60x60-inch acrylic on canvas by Vilas Shinde. Other artists are Pooja Iranna, Dattatraya Apte, Harshavardhana S., Achuthan Kudallur and Anwar Khan. At The Fourth Floor, Kitab Mahal, from September 27 to October 3.

by Aditi Pai